

When Tech Goes Retro!

Step aside, cutting-edge innovation! For it's time for a blast from the past to spice up the tech world. The first half of 2023 has given us a delightful array of attempts to resurrect classic form factors with a healthy sprinkle of modern technology. Brace yourselves, folks, because new tech is serving up nostalgia in a big way!

Let's start with flip phones, the true show-stoppers of the smartphone realm. Thanks to flexible screen tech, these retro wonders are making a grand comeback. Samsung took the lead by unleashing the Galaxy Flip series in 2020, and now every smartphone giant wants a piece of the flipping action. Flip phones are like the holy grail for those of us tired of wielding enormous slabs of technology. Finally, a big-screen phone that can be carried around without worrying about having to fit it into your denim pocket! The latest flip phones even have outer displays, so you can access the basics without having to do the flip-and-twist dance every time. Plus, let's give that poor hinge a break, shall we? It deserves some rest instead of making that dreadful loud snap every time we close it. Sort out the crease and make it perform like a champ in terms of battery life, camera quality, and overall performance, and I'm ready to flip! Sure, they might not be the most affordable devices right now, but I am pretty sure, soon enough we'll see budget-friendly flip phones tantalizing mid-range buyers. It's just a matter of time!

Now, laptops find themselves in a similar predicament. The core hardware has hit the saturation point, leaving tech companies scratching their heads. We've already got more cores and threads than one can ever wish for, and it's not cutting ice any longer. What's their ingenious solution? Bigger screens! That's right, folks. Our sleek and slender laptops are now sporting screens that could double as home movie theaters. Well, not really but they're marching towards it! The race to launch 16 and 17-inch thin and light premium laptops is on, and they want you to believe that bigger screens are the key to your heart. Apple even threw in a MacBook Air with a whopping 15 inches. Personally, I'm partial to a laptop sporting a 14-inch display with slim bezels and a 3:2 aspect ratio when it



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comes to work laptops, but the industry seems to have forgotten all about that. We'll save that rant for another time, though. Perhaps when the world finally comes to its senses and realizes the true beauty of the 14-inch wonder with that magical 3:2 aspect ratio!

Ah, the sweet nostalgia of handheld gaming devices. I still remember my adventures with the dual-screen Donkey Kong 2 from Nintendo, a relic from the golden age of the 1980s. It sits in a trunk, awaiting the day when it becomes a collector's item worth a fortune. Well, guess what? Handheld gaming consoles are making a comeback! The recent launch of the Asus ROG Ally had our resident PC gaming enthusiast, Yetnesh Dubey, jumping for joy. He's hooked on the idea of a portable gaming console that runs on Windows, granting him access to all the PC games in his STEAM library. And judging by the overwhelming response to the Asus ROG Ally, gamers are lining up to get their hands on this piece of gaming heaven. As for me, I'm reserving judgment for now. It's going to take more than just a Windows-based handheld gaming console to replace my trusty keyboard-mouse combo for some hardcore FPS action. The contraption needs to work some serious magic to convince me otherwise! Picture this: you're diving into a fast-paced first-person shooter game, where every millisecond counts. With a handheld gaming device, you're stuck with those tiny buttons and thumbsticks, trying desperately to maintain control and precision. It's like trying to conduct a symphony orchestra with chopsticks. Good luck with that! And please, let's not even mention aim assist. That's like willingly stepping into a world of gaming blasphemy!

The tech world never fails to surprise us. We can only wonder what's next on the agenda for gadgets that blend classic form factors with a modern twist. And let's not forget about the Apple Vision Pro, promising to teleport us into the realm of "Spatial Computing." It's definitely worth keeping an eye on.

So, what's your stance on this retro revolution? Are flip phones and handheld gaming consoles finding their way onto your shopping list? Embrace the nostalgia, my friends, for old is the new new! **d**



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